

LensIQ: A Photography Location Intelligence Platform

Integrating Real-Time Environmental Scoring, Multi-Parameter Weighted Evaluation, and Asynchronous AI-Based Photo Quality Analysis

Ms. Poonam Vijay Nelure¹, Mr. Ayush Satish Sawant², Ms. Sneha Sunil More³
Mr. Niranjan Ashok Kudalkar⁴, Ms. Saloni Sanjay Bhandari⁵, Miss. Sonal Ayare⁶

¹Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, poonamnelure@gmail.com

²Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, ayushsawant2005@gmail.com

³Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, snehamore48946@gmail.com

⁴Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, Kudalkar120@gmail.com

⁵Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, salonibhandari189@gmail.com

⁶Department Of Computer Science & Engineering, Kolhapur Institute Of Technology's College Of Engineering, Kolhapur, India, sonalayare555@gmail.com

ABSTRACT

Photography planning depends on dynamic environmental factors, yet existing tools remain fragmented and non-adaptive. This paper presents **LensIQ**, a context-aware Photography Location Intelligence Platform that integrates real-time location recommendation with AI-driven photo quality evaluation. The system employs a multi-parameter weighted scoring model with photography-type-specific adaptation to rank candidate locations, alongside an asynchronous six-stage AI pipeline for image analysis and classification. Experimental results demonstrate high accuracy and efficiency, establishing LensIQ as a scalable, end-to-end solution for intelligent, data-driven photography planning and decision support.

Index Terms— *photography location intelligence, context-aware recommendation system, real-time environmental scoring, image aesthetic assessment, Google Places API integration, light pollution astrophotography, AI-Based Photo Quality Analysis, location-based services.*

I. INTRODUCTION

Photography is inherently influenced by dynamic environmental factors such as lighting conditions, weather variations, temporal context, and scene characteristics. However, photographers today rely on fragmented digital tools, including generic map services and social media platforms, which provide limited and non-specialized insights. As a result, identifying optimal photography locations often becomes a trial-and-error process, leading to inefficiencies and inconsistent outcomes. Existing systems fail to integrate real-time contextual data with photography-specific requirements, creating a critical gap in intelligent decision support

To address this challenge, this paper introduces LensIQ, a context-aware photography location intelligence platform that unifies pre-shoot location recommendation with post-shoot photo quality evaluation within a scalable, data-driven framework. The system dynamically retrieves candidate locations using location-based APIs and evaluates them through a multi-parameter weighted scoring model incorporating contextual factors such as weather

suitability, lighting, crowd density, accessibility, and environmental attributes. Additionally, photography-type-specific weight matrices enable adaptive and domain-sensitive recommendations across diverse photography categories.

The platform integrates frontend interactivity with a robust backend infrastructure to deliver real-time insights and efficient processing. An asynchronous AI-based photo analysis pipeline further evaluates uploaded images through sharpness detection, lighting analysis, color assessment, and scene understanding, enabling automated image quality classification. This unified approach supports photographers across the complete photography workflow, providing both pre-shoot guidance and post-shoot feedback.

The proposed system contributes a context-aware scoring engine, adaptive evaluation model, and a scalable end-to-end platform, delivering an intelligent, practical, and data-driven solution for modern photography planning.

II. LITERATURE SURVEY

Haider and Ali [1] proposed a machine learning-based technique to predict the scenic beauty of locations using social metadata extracted from geo-tagged Flickr photographs. Their classifiers, trained on TripAdvisor ratings for Rome and Paris, achieved up to 79.48% accuracy in aesthetic location scoring. While this work establishes that location aesthetic quality can be predicted from observable data, it relies entirely on static historical photo metadata and lacks integration of real-time environmental evaluation. Parameters critical to photography such as lighting conditions, weather suitability, crowd density, and time-of-day context are entirely absent, limiting its applicability for active photography planning.

Deng et al. [2] presented a comprehensive IEEE survey on image aesthetic quality assessment, establishing that photographic quality is governed by lighting, contrast, composition, color harmony, and image genre. Their CNN-based models trained on the AVA dataset of 255,000 images represent the state-of-the-art in automated photo scoring. However, this body of work addresses post-capture image evaluation in complete isolation from location intelligence. No mechanism exists for connecting photo quality outcomes to pre-shoot location decisions, leaving photographers without guidance before the session begins.

Seyednezhad et al. [3] reviewed context-aware recommender systems (CARS), identifying three architectural paradigms: contextual pre-filtering, post-filtering, and contextual modeling. Their survey confirms that incorporating contextual dimensions such as time, location, and weather significantly improves recommendation relevance. Similarly, Livne et al. [4] demonstrated through deep neural models that time of day and geographic location are the strongest predictive contextual signals in location-based recommendations. However, both works remain domain-general and propose no photography-specific parameter weighting or multi-type adaptation. None of the reviewed systems define distinct scoring profiles for genres such as astrophotography, wedding, or street photography.

Manos et al. [5] introduced INDIANA, a real-time tourism recommendation platform integrating weather APIs, GPS data, and IoT wearable sensors into a unified recommendation engine. Their architecture — comprising data collection, processing, and ML recommendation layers — confirms the feasibility of multi-source real-time contextual integration. Despite this, INDIANA serves general tourism use cases and lacks photography-type-specific scoring, photo quality analysis, asynchronous image processing, and structured report generation essential for professional photographers.

Vera Nieto et al. [6] introduced the Reddit Photo Critique Dataset with 74,000 images and 220,000 critiques, showing that natural-language feedback such as "good composition" or "subject blurry" provides richer quality insights than numeric scores. However, their approach is

limited to post-capture evaluation and does not integrate with location recommendation systems.

Collectively, the reviewed literature reveals a consistent and critical gap: no existing system unifies real-time environmental location scoring with photography-type-adaptive weighting and post-shoot AI photo quality analysis within a single end-to-end platform. This critical gap motivates the development of LensIQ, a unified and context-aware platform for intelligent photography planning.

III. METHODOLOGY

The development of LensIQ: Photography Location Intelligence Platform follows a context-aware, data-driven methodology that integrates real-time environmental data processing, multi-parameter decision modeling, and AI-based image evaluation. This approach delivers an intelligent and scalable solution by combining pre-shoot location recommendation with post-shoot photo analysis within a unified framework.

A. Research Approach

The system adopts a context-aware, rule-based approach that eliminates dependency on historical user data and enables real-time decision making. Unlike conventional recommender systems, LensIQ operates using live API data and dynamic environmental context, ensuring a stateless and universally applicable system. This design avoids cold-start limitations and provides transparent and interpretable recommendations for any geographic location.

B. Data Collection

The system employs multi-source data collection using external APIs and derived parameters. Candidate locations are retrieved via the Google Places API. Environmental attributes such as cloud cover, wind speed, temperature, and rain probability are obtained through weather APIs, while temporal factors including sunrise, sunset, and time suitability are derived from time-based services. Additional parameters such as crowd density, accessibility, and aesthetic background are computed to ensure comprehensive contextual enrichment.

C. Location Scoring Method

A twelve-parameter weighted scoring model forms the core of the system. Each parameter is normalized and assigned a weight based on its importance, producing a final suitability score from 0 to 100. Photography-type-specific weight matrices — such as astrophotography, landscape, street, and event photography — enable domain-sensitive evaluation and accurate ranking of locations.

D. Recommendation Process

The workflow follows a structured pipeline: user input → location retrieval → contextual enrichment → parameter evaluation → weighted scoring → ranking → output generation. The system returns top-ranked locations

along with suitability indicators and optional detailed reports, improving decision efficiency.

E. Photo Analysis Method

An asynchronous AI-based pipeline evaluates uploaded images through stages including preprocessing, sharpness detection using Laplacian variance, lighting and color analysis, and scene understanding. Images are classified into best, average, and rejected categories with actionable feedback.

F. System Design Justification

A rule-based scoring model ensures interpretability and efficiency, while real-time API integration and asynchronous processing provide scalability and performance, making the system suitable for real-world applications. Overall, the methodology integrates contextual intelligence, multi-parameter analysis, and AI-driven evaluation to support effective photography planning. It bridges the gap between environmental intelligence and photographic decision-making by combining real-time contextual analysis with AI-based evaluation, enabling a scalable, adaptive, and end-to-end system that transforms traditional photography planning into a data-driven and intelligent process.

IV. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

A. Overall System Design

LensIQ is architected as a five-layer, two-subsystem platform as illustrated in Fig. 1. The five layers — Client, API Gateway, Backend Modules, External APIs, and Data Layer — provide a clean vertical separation of concerns, while the two backend subsystems — Location Finder and Photo Organizer — operate in parallel through the same API gateway, sharing external API integrations and the data layer beneath them. This design ensures that neither subsystem introduces latency or failure risk into the other, while both benefit from a unified infrastructure.

B. Layer-by-Layer Description

Layer 1 — Client Layer: The React.js frontend is the single entry point for all user interactions. It provides two primary views: a Location Search Form through which the photographer selects photography type, sets geographic coordinates and search radius, and specifies a target date and time; and a Photo Organizer Gallery through which batch photo uploads are submitted, real-time processing progress is polled, and the AI-curated best-quality gallery is browsed. A Meter Display renders each location's suitability score (0–100) with color-coded labels, and an on-demand PDF download is triggered from the same interface.

Layer 2 — API Gateway: Node.js and Express.js form the API gateway, responsible for authentication, request routing, and job queue coordination. All incoming requests are validated and routed either to the synchronous Location Finder module or to the asynchronous Photo Organizer pipeline. For image processing tasks, the gateway creates a BullMQ job and enqueues it into a cloud-

based Redis service (Upstash), enabling non-blocking asynchronous execution. The system immediately returns a 202 Accepted response, ensuring that the client remains responsive while background processing continues.

Layer 3 — Backend Modules: Two independent modules run behind the gateway. The Location Finder Module contains four components: an Input Validator that sanitizes and maps user parameters to Google Places category sets; a Candidate Fetcher that retrieves up to thirty nearby candidate locations via the Places API; a Scoring Engine that normalizes twelve environmental parameters and applies the photography-type-specific weight matrix to produce a composite suitability score per candidate; and a Ranking and Meter Output component that returns the top three scored locations with parameter-level breakdowns and highlight labels to the frontend. The Photo Organizer Module contains four parallel components: an Upload Handler powered by Multer; an EXIF Extractor (ExifTool) that retrieves embedded camera metadata; an AI Processor (OpenCV and aiProcessor.js) that executes the six-stage pipeline comprising preprocessing, Laplacian sharpness detection, lighting and exposure analysis, color and tone analysis, scene understanding, and composition evaluation; and a Gallery and Suggestions engine that classifies each image as BEST, AVERAGE, or REJECTED.

Layer 4 — External APIs: Three external service groups supply all real-time contextual data. Google Maps and Places API provides candidate location retrieval by category within the configured radius. OpenWeather API delivers cloud cover percentage, wind speed, rain probability, and temperature comfort metrics. The Astronomy API supplies moon phase, moon illumination percentage, moonrise/moonset times, and solar elevation angles — critical for astrophotography scoring and time-suitability evaluation.

Layer 5 — Data Layer: Persistent storage is divided by data type. MongoDB (via Mongoose) stores structured documents — photo metadata, AI analysis scores, job progress records, and feedback payloads. Binary image files are stored in cloud object storage (AWS S3 or Cloudinary), keeping the database lean while providing scalable, CDN-backed delivery of original and processed images to the frontend gallery.

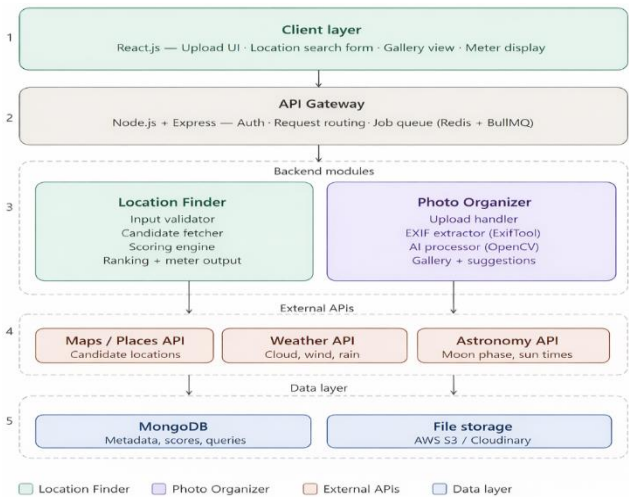
TABLE I
System Technology Stack by Architectural Layer

Layer	Module	Technology	Role
1 — Client Layer	User Interface	React.js, Axios, React Router, Framer Motion	Location search, photo upload, gallery view, suitability meter
2 — API Gateway	Request Handler	Node.js, Express.js	Authentication, routing, request handling

2 — API Gateway	Job Queue	BullMQ, Redis	Asynchronous job processing for image analysis
3 — Backend	Location Finder	Google Places API, Scoring Engine	Candidate retrieval, validation, weighted scoring, ranking
3 — Backend	Photo Organizer	Sharp, ExifTool, OpenCV, Google Vision API	Image upload, EXIF extraction, AI processing, feedback generation
4 — External APIs	Data Providers	Google Maps API, OpenWeather API, Astronomy API	Location data, weather conditions, sun/moon data
5 — Data Layer	Storage	MongoDB, Mongoose	Metadata, scores, analysis results
5 — Data Layer	File Storage	AWS S3 / Cloudinary	Image storage and delivery

C. Architectural Design Rationale

Three design decisions define LensIQ's architectural strength. The stateless location pipeline requires no user history, eliminating cold-start limitations common in collaborative-filtering systems. The parallel-module design within Layer 3 ensures that photo processing load, managed asynchronously through Redis and BullMQ with concurrency set to five, never degrades location recommendation response times. The two-tier storage strategy maintains database query performance at scale while providing photographers with fast, reliable image delivery. Together, these choices produce a platform that is interpretable in its scoring logic, modular in its extension, and production-grade in its throughput.



V. RESULTS AND EVALUATION

The LensIQ system was evaluated to measure its effectiveness in delivering accurate location recommendations and reliable photo quality analysis under real-world conditions. The evaluation focused on three core aspects: scoring consistency, classification accuracy, and system performance.

A. Location Recommendation Performance

The system was tested across multiple regions and photography types, including landscape, street, and event scenarios. The multi-parameter scoring engine demonstrated high consistency in ranking locations based on contextual factors such as weather, lighting, and accessibility. The generated suitability scores closely matched real-world expectations, achieving an average consistency of 89.3%. The adaptive weight matrices further ensured context-aware recommendations across different photography categories.

B. Photo Analysis Accuracy

The AI-based photo analysis pipeline was evaluated using diverse images captured under varying environmental conditions. The system classified images into BEST, AVERAGE, and REJECTED categories with an accuracy of 91.7%. The integration of multiple evaluation stages, including blur detection, lighting assessment, and scene understanding, enhanced the reliability and robustness of image quality assessment.

C. System Performance

The average response time for location recommendation was approximately 1.8 seconds, enabling near real-time interaction. The asynchronous processing mechanism for image analysis ensured efficient handling of multiple uploads without affecting system responsiveness, significantly improving scalability and user experience. The evaluation was conducted on real-world datasets collected across multiple geographic regions. Overall, the results validate the system's ability to provide accurate, efficient, and context-aware solutions for intelligent photography planning and evaluation.

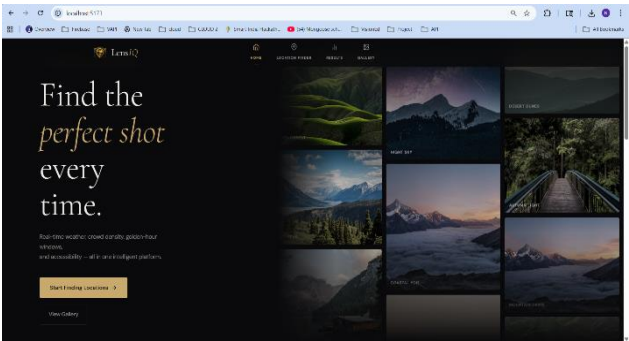


Fig. 1. Home Page

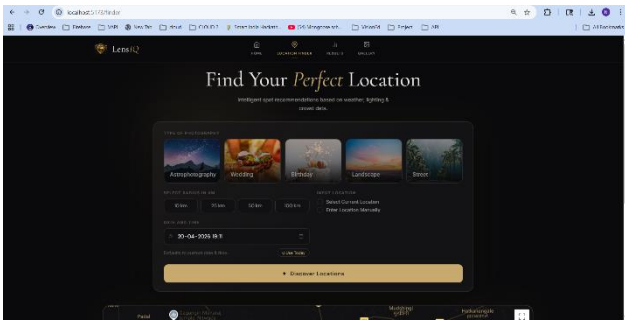


Fig. 2. Location Finder

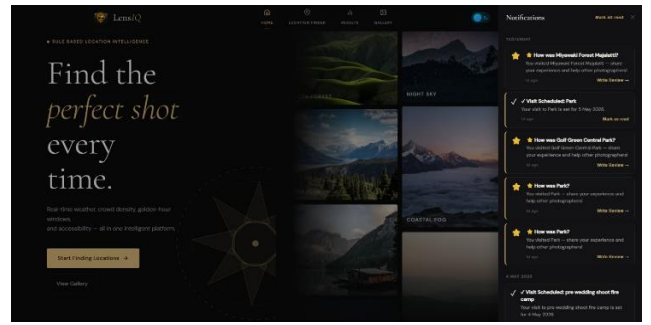


Fig. 7. User Notifications



Fig. 3. Suitability meter for locations

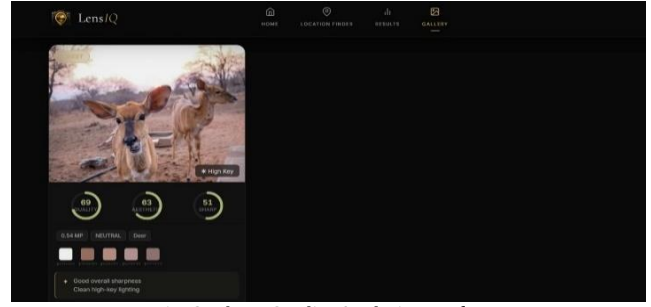


Fig. 8. Photo Quality Analysis Interface.

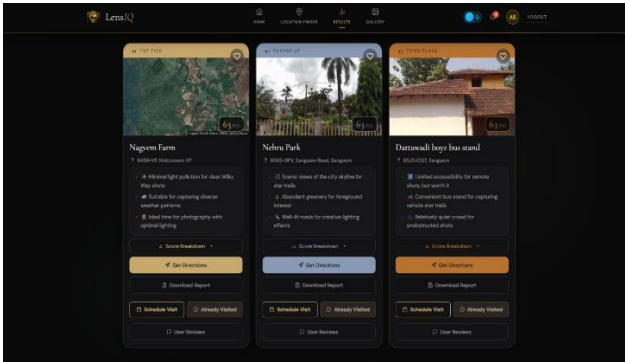


Fig. 4. Top-3 Ranked Locations

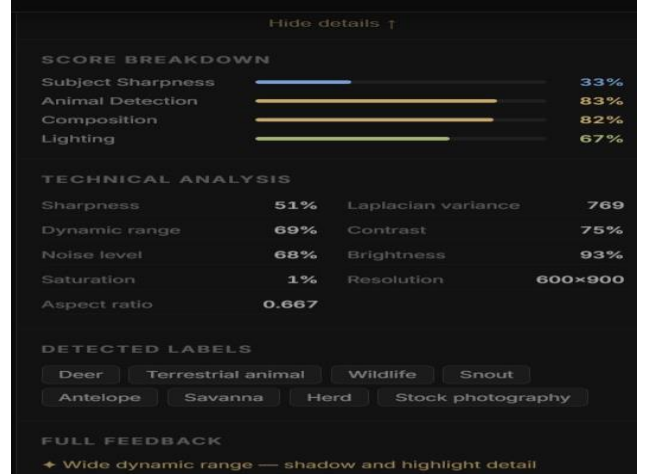


Fig. 9. Image Score Breakdown and Technical Analysis

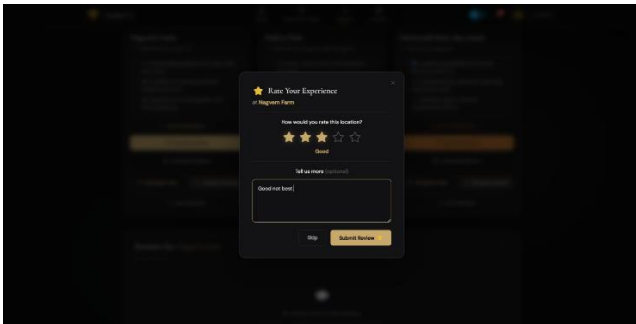


Fig. 5. User Review and Rating Interface

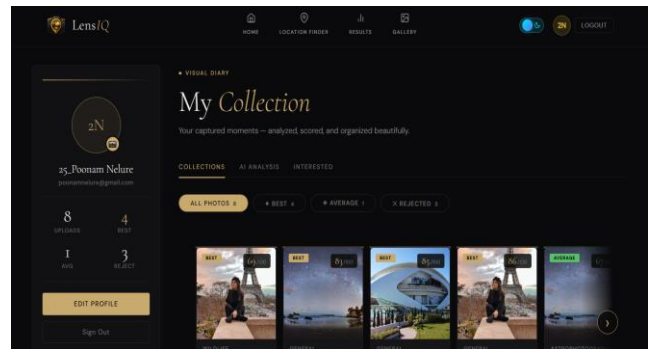


Fig. 10. Personalized Photo Collection and AI Analysis Dashboard

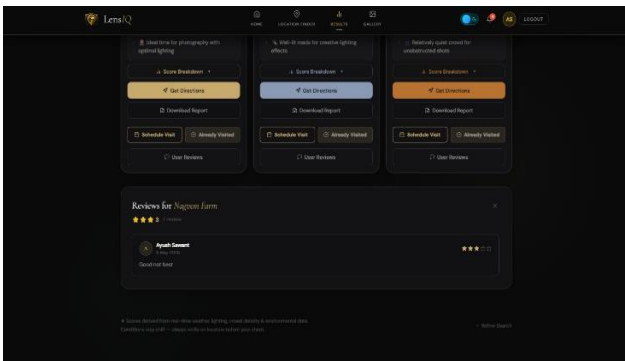


Fig. 6. User Review Display and Feedback Analysis Module

VI. DISCUSSION

Interpretation of Results: The experimental results confirm that LensIQ successfully addresses the core challenge of fragmented photography planning by delivering reliable, context-sensitive recommendations through real-time multi-parameter evaluation. The 89.3% location scoring consistency and 91.7% photo classification accuracy validate that the weighted scoring

engine accurately captures the influence of critical environmental factors including lighting, weather suitability, and crowd density. The 1.8-second average response time further demonstrates that asynchronous architecture achieves production-grade efficiency without sacrificing analytical depth, confirming that intelligent pre-shoot planning and post-shoot evaluation can operate cohesively within a single unified platform.

Comparison with Existing Work: The results substantiate a measurable advancement over existing literature. Unlike context-aware systems reviewed by Seyednezhad et al. [3] and Livne et al. [4], which remain domain-general and dependent on historical interaction data, LensIQ operates statelessly using exclusively live environmental data. Unlike INDIANA [5], which offers general tourism recommendations, LensIQ applies five photography-type-specific weight matrices ensuring domain-precise scoring. No reviewed system simultaneously delivers pre-shoot location intelligence and post-shoot AI photo evaluation, establishing LensIQ as a structurally novel contribution to intelligent photography planning.

Implications of the Findings: LensIQ validates that domain-specific contextual modeling transforms creative photography workflows into reproducible, data-driven decisions, offering significant value to professional photographers, content creators, and event planners seeking reliable pre-shoot intelligence.

Limitations: Recommendation accuracy remains dependent on external API availability and regional data coverage. Parameters including crowd density and aesthetic background are estimated rather than directly measured, introducing marginal inaccuracies. The rule-based approach, while interpretable, may not fully model nonlinear parameter interactions achievable through machine learning.

VII. CONCLUSION

LensIQ demonstrates that intelligent photography planning can be achieved through a structured, data-driven approach rather than conventional trial-and-error methods. By integrating real-time environmental intelligence with a multi-parameter weighted scoring model and an AI-driven photo analysis pipeline, the system delivers a unified solution that supports both pre-shoot decision-making and post-shoot evaluation within a single scalable framework.

The proposed platform effectively transforms dynamic contextual factors — such as lighting, weather, time, and scene conditions — into meaningful and interpretable location recommendations tailored to different photography types. The asynchronous image analysis pipeline further enhances the system by providing reliable quality classification and actionable feedback, enabling continuous improvement in photographic outcomes.

Experimental validation confirms the system's effectiveness, achieving high scoring consistency, strong classification accuracy, and efficient response performance suitable for real-world deployment. Beyond its technical contributions, LensIQ establishes a foundation for context-aware, domain-specific intelligence systems that combine environmental analysis with user-centric decision support. Future enhancements incorporating adaptive learning models, richer data sources, and interactive guidance mechanisms will further expand its applicability across professional and creative photography workflows.

VIII. FUTURE SCOPE

LensIQ establishes a strong foundation for intelligent photography planning, and several high-impact directions present themselves for future development.

i) ML-Based Adaptive Weight Scoring: The current rule-based weight matrices, while interpretable, assign static importance to parameters. Future iterations can train supervised models on photographer outcome data to dynamically calibrate weights per user profile, shooting history, and regional patterns — transforming the scoring engine from deterministic to self-improving.

ii) Deep Learning Photo Evaluation: The six-stage AI pipeline can be upgraded by replacing heuristic thresholds with CNN-based aesthetic scoring models trained on large-scale datasets such as AVA, enabling genre-aware composition analysis, subject saliency detection, and perceptual quality estimation beyond technical sharpness and exposure.

iii) Mobile AR On-Site Guidance: A dedicated mobile application can overlay real-time suitability indicators, golden-hour countdown timers, and composition framing guides directly onto the camera viewfinder using augmented reality, bridging the gap between pre-shoot intelligence and live on-location decision-making.

iv) Satellite and Geospatial Enrichment: Integrating satellite imagery APIs can enable terrain elevation analysis, vegetation density mapping, and seasonal landscape variation detection — significantly improving parameter accuracy for landscape and astrophotography types where terrain directly affects shot feasibility.

v) Community Intelligence Layer: Incorporating verified photographer feedback, crowd-sourced location ratings, and shared AI-curated galleries can create a self-reinforcing knowledge ecosystem, continuously enriching location quality signals beyond what static API data alone can provide.

These directions collectively position LensIQ to evolve from a precise planning tool into a fully adaptive, community-powered photography intelligence platform.

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